CREATOR

OFFICIAL GAME RULEBOOK

Version 1.0

Creator is a two-player, turn-based formation strategy game. Win by arranging your own pawns on every square of the selected target pattern. Both players compete for the same centered formation.

AT A GLANCE	RULE
Board	16 x 16 squares (256 cells)
Teams	BLUE and RED; 32 pawns each
First Move	BLUE
Dice	One six sided die; rolls from 1 to 6
Movement	Any straight-line distance from 1 through the number rolled
Win Condition	100% of the selected target filled by one team
Turn Limit	NONE

1. Goal of the game

Before the match, choose a victory formation. That formation is placed in the center of the board as the common target for both teams. A player wins only when every required target square is simultaneously occupied by that player's own pawns. The opponent's pawns do not count toward your completion. There is no partial-win threshold.

For example, if a formation requires 12 target squares, you must occupy all 12 with your team's pawns at the same time. Occupying 11 of 12 is not a victory.

2. Set up a match

- Open Creator and choose a game mode: Human vs Human, Human vs Basic AI, Human vs Learning AI, or Human vs Advanced AI.

- Choose one of the 53 available victory patterns. The selected pattern is the same objective for both teams.
- Select START GAME. The board and match controls appear.
- BLUE takes the first turn. In AI modes, the human controls BLUE and the Python AI controls RED.

The pattern's exact shape and dimensions come from the selected pattern data. The target is centered by the game engine.

3. Turn sequence

- **Roll:** The active player rolls the six-sided die.
- **Select:** Choose one of your own pawns that has a legal move.
- **Move:** Choose a legal destination within the rolled movement allowance.
- **Resolve:** If the destination contains an enemy pawn, capture and return handling takes place. The engine checks for a completed target formation and advances play as appropriate.

The board highlights legal destinations after a pawn is selected. The Python engine decides which moves are legal.

4. Movement rules

4.1 The die gives a maximum, not an exact distance

If you roll N, you may move a pawn 1, 2, 3, ..., or N squares, provided the move is legal. You are not required to use the entire roll.

DIE RESULT	PERMITTED MOVE LENGTHS
1	1 square
2	1 or 2 squares
3	1, 2, or 3 squares
4	1, 2, 3, or 4 squares
5	1, 2, 3, 4, or 5 squares
6	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, or 6 squares

4.2 Directions and destinations

- Move in one straight line in any of eight directions: north, south, east, west, northeast, northwest, southeast, or southwest.
- The entire move uses one direction; a pawn cannot turn a corner partway through.
- The destination must remain inside the 16 × 16 board.
- You cannot land on a square already occupied by one of your own pawns.
- You may land on an empty square or an opponent's pawn. Landing on an opponent captures it.

4.3 Jumping

A pawn may pass over other pawns on intermediate squares, whether friendly or enemy. Intermediate pieces do not block movement and are not captured. Only the destination square matters for occupancy and capture.

4.4 Example

BLUE rolls 4. A BLUE pawn may move exactly 1, 2, 3, or 4 squares in any single permitted direction. It can jump over a RED pawn two squares away and land on an empty square four squares away. It cannot land on a BLUE pawn, and it cannot move five squares on that roll.

5. Captures, returns, and reserve

When a moving pawn lands on an opposing pawn, the opposing pawn is captured. The moving pawn occupies the destination square. The captured pawn is processed by the engine's home/respawn system; capture does not permanently eliminate it.

- There is no lifetime limit on the number of times a pawn or team may respawn.
- If an eligible home return position is unavailable because home positions are occupied, the captured pawn may be held in reserve until the engine can return it.
- The capture totals shown in the interface are statistics, not remaining lives or a capture quota.

Implementation detail: The precise priority among home squares and the exact timing for releasing reserve pawns depend on the current Python engine. This rulebook intentionally does not invent a fixed ordering or release schedule. For disputes, the current engine behavior is authoritative.

6. Formation victory

- Both teams use the same target formation, centered on the board.
- A player's formation is complete only if 100% of required target cells contain that player's pawns simultaneously.
- An enemy pawn on a required square prevents that square from counting for your team.

- Victory is evaluated by the Python game engine after legal game actions.
- There is no 400-turn cutoff, automatic forced winner, or automatic draw imposed solely because a match has lasted a certain number of turns.

A match may therefore last a long time. Benchmark stopping conditions used by developers are not match-ending rules.

7. Game modes and AI

- **Human vs Human:** Two people alternate turns on the same board and browser session, playing BLUE and RED.
- **Human vs AI:** Choose Basic, Learning, or Advanced on the home screen. You play BLUE; the AI plays RED. The AI uses the same legal-move and victory rules as a human. The Python dice system generates the actual die roll independently; the AI chooses among legal actions and must not alter the die result.

The names Basic, Learning, and Advanced identify different Python opponents. They do not imply different movement privileges, special dice, or separate victory requirements.

8. Website controls

- **START GAME:** Begin a new match using the selected mode and pattern.
- **ROLL DICE:** Roll when the engine indicates your turn is ready for a roll.
- **Board selection:** Click or tap a pawn, then click or tap a highlighted destination.
- **Match information:** The interface shows whose turn it is, the die result, selected pattern, status messages, and capture totals.
- **NEW MATCH / CHANGE PATTERN:** Return to setup and choose a different configuration.
- **RULEBOOK:** Open this document once its PDF link is connected to the website.

9. Examples and clarifications

- **Does a roll of 6 force me to move six squares?**
  No. You may choose any legal distance from 1 to 6 squares.

- **Can I move diagonally?**
  Yes. All four diagonal directions are permitted, as are all four orthogonal directions.

- **Can I jump over my own pawns?**
  Yes. You may jump intermediate pawns of either team. You still cannot land on your own pawn.

- **Can I capture more than one pawn during a move?**
  No. Passing over pieces does not capture them. A normal move captures only an opposing pawn at the destination, if one is there.

- **Can I win with a partly completed formation?**
  No. The required formation must be completely filled by your own team.

- **Can a captured pawn be lost forever?**
  No. The current rules support unlimited respawns, including reserve handling when home positions are occupied.

- **Is the match declared a draw after 400 turns?**
  No. There is no fixed gameplay turn limit.

- **Can the AI choose a favorable die roll?**
  No. Dice generation is separate from the AI decision process.

10. Fair play and rule authority

BLUE and RED follow symmetric movement and victory rules. The active Python engine validates movement, captures, target completion, and turn transitions. Browser highlights are guidance, not an alternative rule engine.

If a displayed highlight or a written example disagrees with a legal-action decision made by the current engine, the discrepancy should be reported and corrected; it is not permission to bypass server validation.

11. Glossary

Term	Meaning
Target/ Formation	The selected set of required board squares
Legal move	A move accepted by the Python engine under the current die roll
Capture	Landing on an enemy pawn and sending it through return handling
Home	A team's designated return/start area
Reverse	Holding area for pawns awaiting a permitted return

AI turn	A turn controlled by a Python AI opponent
Complete formation	Every required target square occupied by the same team

12. Official links and publication

- **Play Creator:** https://creator-game.onrender.com/
- **Source code and updates:** https://github.com/dkconnect/Creator

Created by Dibyanshu. This document describes the agreed current rules of the Version 1 release. Historical prototypes used different rules and should not be treated as the current rulebook.